

TIMELINE

- **January 8, 1821** Born at Hopewell, Edgefield District, South Carolina, third son of James Longstreet, a cotton plantation owner.
- **1842** Graduates from West Point and is assigned to 4th Infantry Division, Jefferson Barracks in Missouri.
- **1846** War with Mexico breaks out. Assumes command of a company in June.
- **1847** Brevetted major for his performance at Molino del Ray; wounded at Chapultepec.
- **1848** Marries Maria Louisa Garland.
- **1852** Promoted to captain of infantry.
- **1859** Assigned to duty in New Mexico Territory.
- **1861** Accepts commission as brigadier general in Provisional Army of the Confederate States. Commands at Blackburn's Ford (July), before First Bull Run. Promoted to major general in October.
- **May-December 1862** Fights at Williamsburg during the Peninsula Campaign, orchestrates the Confederate victory at Second Bull Run, and commands the right wing of Lee's army at Antietam. Promoted to lieutenant general, he takes command of First Corps. Commands the defense at Marye's Heights, Fredericksburg.
- **July-November 1863** Now Lee's favorite lieutenant since the death of Jackson, Longstreet is fatefully linked with the disastrous Pickett's Charge at Gettysburg. Breaks the Union line at Chickamauga. Takes part in East Tennessee Campaign, resulting in failed siege of Knoxville.
- **May-October 1864** Returns to Virginia and commands the counterattack during the Battle of the Wilderness, where he is critically wounded. Recovers to command the First Corps north of the James River during the siege of Petersburg.
- **April 9, 1865** Surrenders with Lee and the Army of Northern Virginia at Appomattox.
- **1868** Joins the Republican Party.
- **1875** Purchases Parkhill Farm in Gainesville, Georgia, and settles there.
- **1880** Appointed Minister to Ottoman Turkey.
- **1889** Maria Louisa Garland Longstreet dies.
- **1896** Publishes his autobiography.
- **1897** Marries Helen Dortch, aged 34, in Atlanta.
- **1904** Dies in Gainesville, two days before his 83rd birthday.